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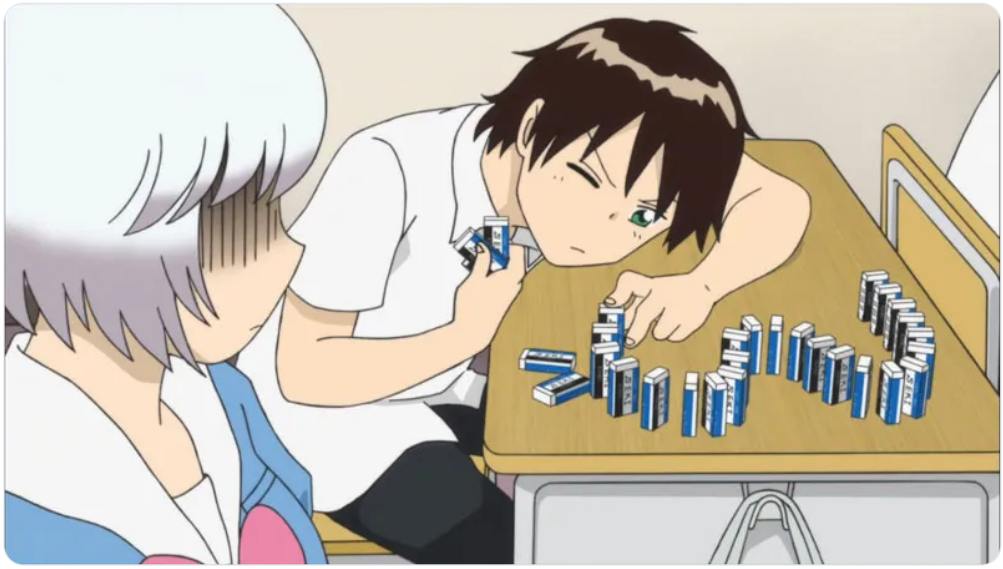
Iran vs Israel Part #4: Playing with dominoes [Bonus]
Putting it all together:
In the previous threads we learnt about what Israel had done, how game theory works, why Iran HAD to reply (which it did).
Now we will talk about how this entire thing can end up becoming WWIII. /



In the previous thread, we spoke of the peace dividend, death spirals, and how they necessitated two different possible choices:
a) A change of strategy preemptive an inescapable death spiral into defeat/extinction.
b) Bringing in outside help at a cost.

https://twitter.com/cirnosad/status/1776842636395208711

In fact, it's more correct to say, sometimes outside help will come on its own. How can that be? Are nations or organisations truly that altruistic? Not quite.

For now, let's take a step back to talk about extended peace and the complications it brings!

Just as we covered how extended peace guaranteed eventual wars between two nations, through the build up of economic and military potential, overextended peace can guarantee something even worse: International Systemic complexity.
In other words, complicated inter-dependencies.

Let us say that two strong trade partners, with differing military potential neighbour each other. A long period of peace makes these bonds grow strong.
A third, hostile nation decides to declare war on the weaker of the two but not the stronger.
What should the strong nation do?

On the surface, you might think "do nothing", as war is costly and since no war was declared? Why bother.

Well, consider the damage that would happen should the hostile nation defeat your friendly neighbour:
You lose the economic bonds...
... But also one safe border!

Eventually you will be forced to confront the enemy, who will now take over many of the things that made your country strong, and be able to enjoy a larger proportion of the peace dividend... until they declare war again, on you!

So why wait until you have to confront them?

The correct choice is to support your ally: Not necessarily to win (it can be difficult or costly), but at least to prevent the other party from winning. Sometimes you can even turn your ally into a captive ally (vassal), through extension of the war and light assistance.

I used the example of economic bonds, but ideological, religious and other bonds (logistical, such as waterways) are all equally serious grounds for joining a war.
The war can be joined covertly (like the US in Ukraine) or overtly (e.g. SMO defense of the Donbass).

In the previous thread we spoke of two nations, and now we speak of three, but it doesn't end there, and it may not necessarily be a strong nation coming in to defend a weak one.
It can also be a weak nation coming in to preempt attacks on a strong one it will need in the future!

On the grand chess board are four important nations:

1. Russia
2. China
3. USA
4. Iran

Right now, these countries are at war [economic, overt and covert], and they have complex relationships with each other. The US is the strongest, but together the other three can overpower it.

In 2022, 🇺🇸 decided to go after what it thought to be the weaker of 🇨🇳 & 🇷🇺 (the latter), by threatening the Donbass using 🇺🇦. This dragged Russia into war, which had Russian troops inside 🇺🇦.

Then 🇺🇸 dragged the EU into the war out of its fear of an equilibrium shift by 🇷🇺.

China supported Russia lightly, hoping to make it dependent on its economic power. But Russia's military prowess proved to be formidable. So much so that the US was forced to look outside of the theatre and attack Russia's most vulnerable ally:🇸🇾
With a 2nd regime change attempt!

Most do not remember this but weeks before operation Al Aqsa storm, Syria was dealing with an uprising in Sweida province. The Druze, who refused to sign up to military conscription through Syria's war, suddenly decided to go on the offensive against the government w/ MI6 support

In the background, Israel (which wanted Syria gone), had recruited Sheikh Muafak Tarif to get the Druze to rise up. The deal was successful, and extremely damaging demonstrations were active, destroying Syrian government property, right across from the Jordanian & Israeli border.

Syria, at this point, was on life support, due to VERY light support from Russia and exceedingly light support from Iran. Due to sanctions, it could not afford to quell this second uprising. The right was on the wall, at the time I said Syria looks like it was about to collapse.

This would have been terrible for Russia and Iran. Syria was the strategic depth of all of Iran's alliances. For Russia, Tartous and Latakia formed the underbelly that made the Black sea relevant.

Syria could not be allowed to fall for either. America may have pushed too far!

Days later, the 50th anniversary of the 1973 passed. On October 6th, 2023. It seemed that Israel would no longer suffer war, after having faced Hafez Al Assad's declaration of war in that time, which dragged both the USSR and the US into overt confliction!

https://www.youtube.com/embed/_naf9xtg0NM

...But they were wrong. Iran's ally, Hamas/PIJ and other Palestinian groups were mobilising on that same day to launch an operation that changed the course of history:

Operation Al Aqsa flood.

This completely tilted the balance, and everyone forgot about the Syria situation.

When Israel would not accept its defeat by Hamas and launched a genocidal campaign on Gaza, it was clear to me that the rest of the resistance couldn't stand idle. Should Israel have won, it would come after them, as it would have less and less pressure with each victory.

In this manner, each failure to support an ally would make an enemy more dangerous and have a greater capacity/will to wage war on a new player.

Essentially, an inter-player higher order death spiral!
Thus I stated out that 7 fronts were ready for Israel:

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North Korea and Iran have a special relationship that is often not covered in the media. Syria was in fact the initiator of this relationship. During the Iran-Iraq war, Syria helped Iran with its missile program, with some samples from Libya and with its connections to Korea.

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Iran-North Korea-Syria Ballistic Missile and Nuclear Cooperation

Paul K. Kerr
Analyst in Nonproliferation

Steven A. Hildreth
Specialist in U.S. and Foreign National Security Programs

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Specialist in Nonproliferation

February 26, 2016

As such, for North Korea, should Iran fall, it would most certainly be next. NK relies on Iran for many raw materials that it needs for its massive MIC, missile and nuclear program. In turn, Iran needs North Korea for higher order purposes and strategic balance.

The same relationship exists today between Russia and Iran, after Iran sent Shahed-136 samples/blueprints to Russia. In fact, even without this, the Russians cannot allow their Iranian neighbour to fall to the US: It would tilt the international balance to the US's favour in war!

And so, the pieces are set. Interlocking relationships and systemic complexity, as well as a psychotic player (🇮🇱) which wishes to put itself in danger in order to force its ally (🇺🇸) into a war it doesn't want to wage.
And it all started in Syria!

What will come next? WW3? /End

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